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► To cite this version:

Arjun Kamisetty. The Role of Cybersecurity in Safeguarding Cross-Border E-Commerce and Economic Growth. Asian Business Review, 2024, 14 (2), pp.85-94. <10.18034/abr.v14i2.739>. <hal-04909581>

HAL Id: hal-04909581

<https://hal.science/hal-04909581v1>

Submitted on 24 Jan 2025

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The Role of Cybersecurity in Safeguarding Cross-Border E-Commerce and Economic Growth

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<https://doi.org/10.18034/abr.v14i2.739>

ABSTRACT

This research examines how cybersecurity protects cross-border e-commerce and boosts economic development. With digital commerce growing rapidly, the study examines how strong cybersecurity standards affect customer trust, corporate resilience, and international trade. The research analyzes cybersecurity issues, new technologies, and their economic effects on cross-border e-commerce using secondary data from peer-reviewed journals, industry reports, and regulatory papers. Secure digital platforms are crucial to customer trust, and strong cybersecurity policies may limit financial risks, facilitate corporate innovation, and help SMEs in global marketplaces. Artificial intelligence, blockchain, and sophisticated encryption improve cybersecurity and secure e-commerce platforms. The report also highlights legislative fragmentation and the need for international collaboration to standardize cybersecurity standards. Governments must create collaborative frameworks, encourage firms to embrace cutting-edge security solutions and promote digital literacy to raise consumer awareness. Businesses and governments can build a safe digital trade environment that boosts economic development, minimizes risks, and opens new global commerce possibilities by closing cybersecurity gaps.

Key words: Cybersecurity, Cross-Border E-Commerce, Economic Growth, Digital Trade, Consumer Trust, Payment Fraud, Blockchain, Artificial Intelligence

INTRODUCTION

E-commerce has transformed conventional trade and allowed firms to expand globally in the digital economy. Technology, global connection, and consumer demand for different products and services have propelled exponential development in cross-border e-commerce. Cross-border e-commerce drives global economic development by enabling trade, innovation, and financial integration as firms and consumers embrace this borderless marketplace (Mallipeddi, 2022; Goda, 2020; Ahmmed et al., 2021; Devarapu, 2020; Sachani et al., 2022; Talla, 2022; Rodriguez et al., 2021; Thompson et al., 2019; Rodriguez et al., 2023; Allam et al., 2024; Farhan et al., 2024; Gummadi, 2024; Kommineni et al., 2024; Kothapalli et al., 2024; Manikyala 2024; Manikyala et al., 2024). This fast growth is hampered by cybersecurity issues that jeopardize its long-term viability.

Cybercriminals target cross-border e-commerce platforms, making cybersecurity crucial. Financial fraud,

data breaches, intellectual property theft, and supply chain disruptions may damage consumer confidence and international commerce (Talla, 2023; Dhameliya et al., 2021; Farhan et al., 2024; Gummadi, 2022; Talla et al., 2021). Cybersecurity flaws may disclose sensitive data and threaten national security as governments and corporations use digital ecosystems for smooth interactions (Gummadi et al., 2021; Kamisetty et al., 2023; Narsina et al., 2022; Onteddu et al., 2022; Richardson et al., 2023; Roberts et al., 2020; Talla et al., 2022). The differences in cybersecurity maturity among areas make these difficulties even more complicated, making attacks traverse boundaries.

Cybersecurity and economic development are especially linked in cross-border e-commerce. Consumer confidence, investment, and innovation depend on secure, robust digital infrastructures. Conversely, cybersecurity disasters may cause significant financial losses, brand harm, and regulatory fines, slowing economic activity and global commerce (Gummadi, 2023; Talla et al., 2023;



Rodriguez et al., 2020; Kamisetty, 2022; Devarapu, 2021; Narsina et al., 2019). Due to its crucial relevance, policymakers, corporations, and international organizations are pushing to develop comprehensive cybersecurity safeguards for cross-border e-commerce (Devarapu et al., 2019; Gummadi et al., 2020; Maddula, 2023; Kamisetty et al., 2021; Kothapalli, 2022; Mullangi et al., 2023; Narsina et al., 2021).

This article examines cybersecurity's diverse function in facilitating cross-border e-commerce and economic development. It analyzes how cybersecurity protects and builds confidence in global digital marketplaces. This study shows that governments, private sector players, and international entities must work together to address cybersecurity trends, problems, and possibilities. Emerging technologies like AI, blockchain, and improved encryption reduce hazards and enhance cross-border transaction security.

Case studies of effective cybersecurity tactics in cross-border e-commerce ecosystems illuminate best practices and lessons learned. They also emphasize the need for harmonized international standards and frameworks to maintain cybersecurity coherence in the regulatory environment.

Cross-border e-commerce and global economic development depend on cybersecurity, which is both defensive and strategic. As the digital economy evolves, cybersecurity must be strengthened to maximize cross-border commerce, innovation, and equal access to global markets. By tackling these concerns, stakeholders may boost economic development while protecting the global e-commerce ecosystem.

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

Cross-border e-commerce has transformed the global economy, creating new possibilities for firms and consumers. This digital change has boosted international commerce, innovation, and economic development by facilitating cross-border transactions (Kothapalli et al., 2019; Maddula et al., 2023; Manikyala et al., 2024; Mullangi et al., 2018). These gains come with a significant drawback: cyber-attacks are becoming more sophisticated and widespread. Data breaches, fraud, and supply chain disruptions threaten cross-border e-commerce's integrity and sustainability (Kothapalli et al., 2024). Despite the necessity for strong cybersecurity, the complicated relationship between cybersecurity, cross-border e-commerce, and economic development is still poorly understood (Kundavaram et al., 2018).

Cybersecurity is crucial to digital trade, but research seldom examines its significance in cross-border e-commerce. Cybersecurity studies have focused on technology or regions, leaving a void in the literature on its worldwide effects on cross-border commerce

ecosystems. Several studies have examined the economic consequences of cyber risks, but few have shown how improved cybersecurity may promote cross-border e-commerce and sustainable economic growth (Maddula, 2018; Kothapalli, 2021). This gap highlights the need for a more holistic approach to understanding cybersecurity's role in safe and trustworthy international commerce.

This research investigates how cybersecurity protects cross-border e-commerce and affects economic development to fill these gaps. To help cross-border e-commerce succeed, cybersecurity must be understood about consumer trust, corporate confidence, and regulatory compliance. The report also examines how blockchain, AI, and sophisticated encryption might improve cybersecurity frameworks to satisfy digital economy needs.

This study may reconcile theoretical insights with practical implementations, providing policymakers, corporations, and international organizations with concrete suggestions. Research on cybersecurity and cross-border e-commerce adds to the discussion on how safe digital ecosystems may support inclusive and fair economic development. It also stresses the significance of cross-sector and international collaboration in creating global cybersecurity standards and rules for e-commerce.

Without effective cybersecurity, cross-border e-commerce system vulnerabilities may lower customer trust, corporate operations, and economic potential. This research highlights how cybersecurity might move from a defensive mechanism to a strategic facilitator of global economic success. The project aims to establish robust, secure, and sustainable cross-border e-commerce ecosystems by solving research gaps and concentrating on practical findings. It emphasizes integrating cybersecurity into digital commerce and economic policy to maximize globalization and digitalization's advantages while minimizing hazards.

METHODOLOGY OF THE STUDY

This secondary data-based research examines how cybersecurity protects cross-border e-commerce and boosts economic development. This study is based on a thorough literature evaluation of peer-reviewed academic papers, industry reports, government publications, and policy briefs. The research integrates cybersecurity, international commerce, and economic development to comprehend the topic. The report examines cross-border e-commerce cybersecurity tendencies, issues, and possibilities. Cybersecurity measures' efficacy and influence on economic growth are assessed using case studies, statistical data, and best practices. This study uses reputable and varied secondary sources to fill information gaps and give suggestions for policymakers, firms, and stakeholders in the global e-commerce ecosystem.

CYBERSECURITY CHALLENGES IN CROSS-BORDER E-COMMERCE ECOSYSTEMS

Cross-border e-commerce has revolutionized the global marketplace by providing consumers and companies' access to a wide range of products and services and unmatched development potential. However, because of

its dependence on digital platforms, cross-border transactions, and linked supply chains, cross-border e-commerce is also vulnerable to cybersecurity issues. These issues jeopardize the broader economic development that cross-border e-commerce promotes, in addition to its integrity and reliability.



Figure 1: Cybersecurity Challenges in Cross-Border E-Commerce Ecosystems

Figure 1 depicts the main cybersecurity issues encountered by cross-border e-commerce platforms. The subject "Cybersecurity Challenges" includes Threats, Compliance, Technology, and Workforce. Each division examines international e-commerce security challenges. Phishing, malware, foreign rules, aging systems, talent shortages, and the requirement for continual training are among them.

One of the most urgent issues is the frequency of identity theft and data breaches. Platforms for cross-border e-commerce manage enormous volumes of private customer and company data, such as trade secrets, payment details, and personal identifiers. Cybercriminals often target this information in phishing schemes, fraud, and dark web sales. In addition to causing companies significant financial and reputational damage, these breaches erode customer confidence, essential to maintaining e-commerce transactions (Moga et al., 2016).

Financial hacking and payment fraud are yet another formidable obstacle. Multiple currencies, payment methods, and intermediaries are all involved in cross-border transactions, which makes the financial system complex and open to abuse. Attackers may use ransomware attacks to blackmail companies or card-not-present fraud, using stolen payment information for illegal activities. The absence of uniform security procedures across payment systems, especially in areas with less robust cybersecurity regimes, makes these risks worse.

Supply chain weaknesses also seriously threaten cross-border e-commerce. Because global supply chains are intertwined, a security compromise in one area might affect other stakeholders in a cascading manner. Cyberattacks that target third-party suppliers, inventory management systems, or logistics providers may cause delays in the timely delivery of products, resulting in

monetary losses and damaged business relationships. Due to their sometimes insufficient security, the proliferation of Internet of Things (IoT) devices in supply chain management has significantly increased the attack surface.

National differences in cybersecurity maturity and regulatory fragmentation add another degree of complication. While some countries have implemented strict cybersecurity and data protection legislation, others are behind in creating all-encompassing frameworks. This discrepancy raises the expenses of maintaining cybersecurity measures, makes it more difficult for companies operating across borders to comply with regulations, and leaves vulnerabilities that hackers might exploit (Kahyaoglu & Caliyurt, 2018).

Furthermore, organizations' capacity to successfully fight against cyber threats is tested by their fast development and the emergence of sophisticated attack techniques like advanced persistent threats (APTs) and zero-day vulnerabilities. Small and medium-sized businesses (SMEs), which comprise a sizable share of participants in cross-border e-commerce, are especially at risk because they lack the means and know-how to implement strong cybersecurity measures.

A multifaceted strategy, including international cooperation, technical innovation, and the creation of global cybersecurity standards, is needed to address these issues. Emerging technologies like blockchain for safe transactions and artificial intelligence for danger detection can mitigate risk. To promote a culture of cybersecurity awareness, exchange threat information, and unify rules, governments, corporations, and international organizations must work together in tandem with their implementation.

Ultimately, maintaining customer confidence, safeguarding corporate interests, and guaranteeing e-commerce's continuous contribution to global economic development depends on identifying and resolving cybersecurity issues in cross-border e-commerce ecosystems.

EMERGING TECHNOLOGIES ENHANCING E-COMMERCE CYBERSECURITY FRAMEWORKS

As cross-border e-commerce has grown, cybersecurity has become a crucial component of online trade. Emerging technologies are becoming essential tools for strengthening e-commerce cybersecurity frameworks as cyber threats increase in complexity and size. In addition to addressing current vulnerabilities, these advances make proactive risk mitigation, customer trust, and sustainable economic development methods possible. This chapter examines how cutting-edge technologies like blockchain, artificial intelligence (AI), and sophisticated encryption are changing the cybersecurity environment of international e-commerce.

Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence: By facilitating automated responses, predictive analytics, and real-time threat detection, artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning (ML) are transforming cybersecurity. AI-driven algorithms may analyze large datasets to find trends that point to cyberattacks, such as odd login attempts, illegal access, or fraudulent transactions. Thanks to this capacity, businesses may identify dangers and take appropriate action before they do serious harm; one of the biggest problems in international e-commerce is payment fraud, which machine learning models are very good at preventing. These algorithms are very accurate in detecting abnormalities and flagging suspicious activity by examining transaction data from the past. Furthermore, in a setting where fraudsters often develop new techniques, AI-powered solutions are essential because they can constantly adjust to changing threats (Dhar & Manimegalai, 2018).

Secure Transactions using Blockchain: A decentralized, impenetrable foundation for safeguarding international e-commerce transactions is provided by blockchain technology. Transparency and trust are increased by its immutable ledger, ensuring that transaction data cannot be changed or falsified. Blockchain is instrumental in addressing supply chain vulnerabilities by enabling end-to-end visibility of items and confirming their legitimacy. Blockchain provides safe peer-to-peer transactions for payment systems, lowering the need for intermediaries and the possibility of financial fraud. Blockchain's built-in cryptographic features further secure private information, guaranteeing

that customer data is safe throughout the transaction process (Xiao, 2018).

Secure Communication and Advanced Encryption:

Sophisticated encryption methods protect private information sent across international e-commerce networks. Even if communication lines are hacked, end-to-end encryption guarantees that data is safe from interception. Contemporary encryption standards protect against increasingly sophisticated cyber threats, including quantum-resistant algorithms. E-commerce platforms often use the Secure Sockets Layer (SSL) and Transport Layer Security (TLS) protocols to create encrypted connections and safeguard consumer data during online transactions. Furthermore, developments in homomorphic encryption enable the safe processing of sensitive data by permitting calculations on encrypted data without disclosing it (Xiao et al., 2016).

The Role of Emerging Technologies in Regulatory

Compliance: Additionally, emerging technologies are essential for assisting companies in adhering to global cybersecurity and data protection laws. AI may detect any weaknesses resulting in non-compliance and automate compliance assessments. While encryption guarantees compliance with data privacy rules like the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), blockchain's transparency fits well with regulatory requirements for data traceability and responsibility.

Cross-border e-commerce cybersecurity frameworks are changing due to emerging technology, which provides creative answers to complex problems. By integrating AI, blockchain, and sophisticated encryption, companies may improve platform security, safeguard customer information, and promote confidence in the global digital marketplace. These solutions promote the long-term expansion and resilience of cross-border e-commerce ecosystems and meet urgent cybersecurity demands. Their acceptance and advancement will be crucial to guarantee that cybersecurity continues to be a strategic facilitator of global economic advancement (Broome, 2016).

Table 1 details the expenses of deploying blockchain technology to improve cross-border e-commerce cybersecurity. It compares the costs of setup, maintenance, and transaction fees against the transparency, decreased fraud, and immutable data blockchain might offer to e-commerce platforms. The table also assesses ROI, including predicted fraud-related loss reductions and client retention gains. The application cases for blockchain in e-commerce cybersecurity include supply chain monitoring, secure payment systems, and identity management.

Table 1: Cost-Benefit Analysis of Blockchain for E-Commerce Cybersecurity

Blockchain Implementation Cost	Benefits	Return on Investment (ROI)	Use Cases
High (cost of developing or integrating blockchain systems)	Ensures precise, immutable transaction records, enhancing trust	Lower fraud risks due to transparency and verification	Blockchain ensures complete visibility and traceability of goods across borders
Medium (ongoing upkeep, security patches, and system updates)	Blockchain reduces the risk of fraudulent transactions through secure, transparent processes	Customers are more likely to return if they trust the platform's security	Blockchain-based payments provide secure, fast, and low-cost transaction solutions
Low to medium (depending on the blockchain network used)	Once a transaction is recorded, it cannot be altered, reducing the chances of data tampering	Reduced transaction fees, eliminated intermediaries (e.g., banks), and fewer chargebacks	Blockchain can securely store user credentials and protect against identity theft
Varies (depending on compatibility with existing systems and training)	Reduces reliance on centralized authorities, increasing resilience to attacks	Automation of processes reduces human error, enhancing overall business productivity	Automatically executed agreements on blockchain, improving trust and reducing disputes

ECONOMIC GROWTH THROUGH SECURE DIGITAL TRADE PRACTICES

Promoting economic development is significantly impacted by incorporating safe digital trade practices into international e-commerce. Cybersecurity is one of the most critical factors in maintaining global e-commerce expansion. Strong cybersecurity procedures safeguard

stakeholders and facilitate innovation, investment, and cross-border cooperation by guaranteeing digital commerce's integrity, dependability, and credibility. This chapter examines the broader ramifications for companies, customers, and governments and how safe digital trading practices support economic expansion (Bordoff et al., 2017).

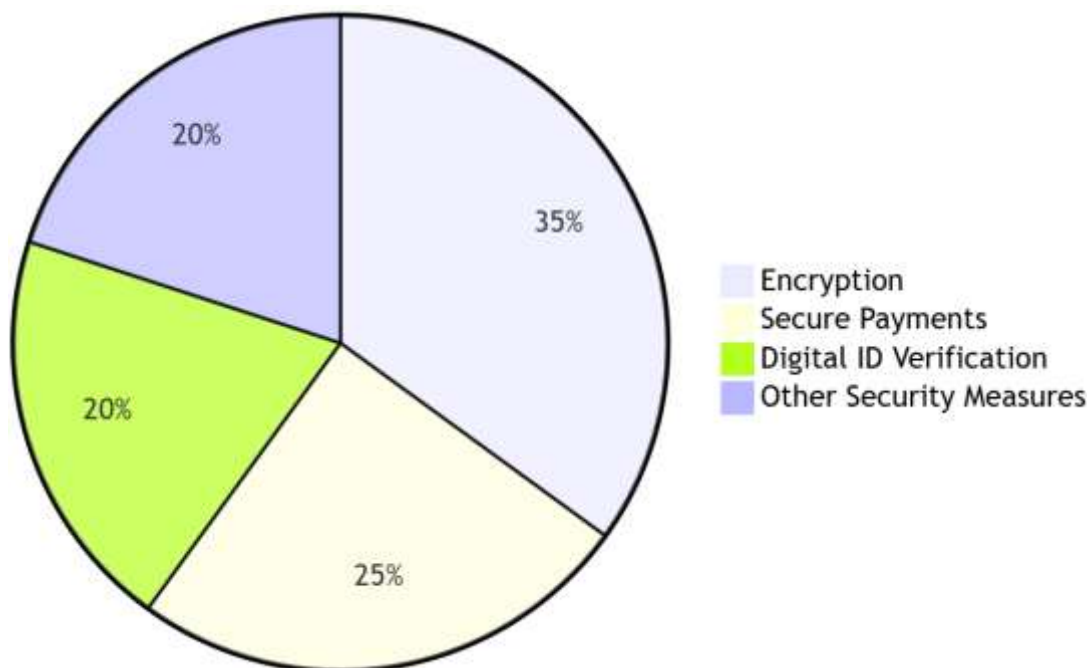


Figure 2: Proportions of Secure Digital Trade Practices Contributing to Economic Growth

The Figure 2 pie chart shows how each digital commerce technique boosts economic growth:

Encryption protects sensitive data in digital transactions (35%).

Digital economies need Secure Payments (25%), which prevents fraud and ensures seamless transactions.

Trusted identities in cross-border commerce need 20% digital ID verification.

Other Security Measures (20%) include legislative frameworks and security mechanisms for safe digital commerce.

Building Consumer Trust and Driving Demand:

Consumer trust is the foundation of cross-border e-commerce. Customers are more willing to shop online, especially in foreign markets, when they believe their financial and personal information is safe. By creating a secure environment for e-commerce, cybersecurity features like multi-factor authentication, encrypted communications, and secure payment gateways increase confidence. Businesses see increased income due to increased demand for products and services and increased customer trust. Additionally, secure platforms draw in recurring business, creating enduring connections that support economic growth and stability. On the other hand, fraud and data breaches brought on by weak cybersecurity may undermine customer confidence, reduce consumer spending, and impede market growth (Kshetri, 2016).

Facilitating Business Expansion and Innovation: Secure digital trade procedures lower companies' dangers while managing cross-border operations and breaking into new markets. Businesses may invest in technology, infrastructure, and alliances with confidence when they have a robust cybersecurity framework in place since they won't have to worry about suffering significant losses from hacks. Because of this security, businesses can develop and provide new goods, services, and solutions suited to customers' needs worldwide. Secure digital trading practices are especially advantageous for small and medium-sized businesses (SMEs). By implementing appropriate cybersecurity measures, SMEs may broaden their reach, compete in foreign markets, and support domestic and global economies. Additionally, companies that put cybersecurity first can better satisfy the demands of regulatory bodies and trading partners, giving them an advantage in the global economy (Pestic, 2018).

Enhancing Supply Chain Resilience: A crucial component of cross-border e-commerce, secure digital trading procedures also strengthen supply

chain resilience. Supply chain-related cyberattacks can cause significant operational disruptions, shipping delays, and financial losses. Businesses may protect their operations from cyber risks by implementing IoT security standards and blockchain for supply chain transparency. A robust supply chain guarantees the timely delivery of products and services, which is crucial for preserving economic activity and customer satisfaction. Additionally, trustworthy supply chains encourage cooperation and investment in international e-commerce ecosystems by boosting trust among trading partners (Lis & Mendel, 2019).

Promoting International Cooperation and Policy

Harmonization: As governments and organizations collaborate to create global cybersecurity standards, adopting safe digital commerce promotes international collaboration. Harmonized rules level the playing field for companies globally, lower trade obstacles, and enable more seamless transactions. Thus, secure trade procedures help achieve the larger objectives of globalization and economic integration by allowing nations to take advantage of chances for mutual progress.

Cross-border e-commerce's steady economic expansion depends on safe digital trading practices. Cybersecurity serves as both a protection and an accelerator of economic advancement by promoting supply chain resilience, facilitating corporate development, and safeguarding customer data. Furthermore, international cooperation and policy harmonization guarantee the equitable distribution of these advantages across areas. Businesses, governments, and stakeholders looking to fully realize the promise of global e-commerce will continue to prioritize investing in safe trade processes as the digital economy develops.

MAJOR FINDINGS

This research examined cybersecurity's complex role in protecting cross-border e-commerce and boosting economic development. A thorough secondary data assessment revealed numerous key facts highlighting the need for strong cybersecurity in the global digital commerce ecosystem.

Cybersecurity as a Cornerstone of Consumer

Trust: Cybersecurity affects consumer trust, which is crucial to cross-border e-commerce. The results demonstrate that secure digital platforms, which include encryption, authentication, and secure payment processes, boost customer trust. Data breaches and identity theft destroy confidence, discouraging cross-border transactions and limiting e-commerce development without proper protection.

Financial Stability through Mitigation of Cyber Threats:

The survey found that cross-border e-commerce enterprises face considerable financial risks from cyber threats, including payment fraud, ransomware, and phishing. SME cybersecurity risks are incredibly high since they generally lack the means to install sophisticated cybersecurity measures. Businesses that invest in strong cybersecurity systems reduce financial losses, improve operational efficiency, and maintain worldwide expansion.

Technological Innovations Strengthening Cybersecurity: AI, blockchain, and improved encryption are transforming e-commerce cybersecurity. Blockchain technology provides transaction and supply chain transparency and immutability, while AI-driven solutions identify and forecast threats. These solutions decrease risks and safeguard international commerce, enabling smooth and reliable cross-border operations.

Supply Chain Resilience through Secure Practices:

Supply chain vulnerabilities plague cross-border e-commerce. Cyberattacks on logistics and third-party providers may interrupt commerce and cost money. According to the report, secure digital commerce practices boost resilience, including IoT security standards and blockchain for supply chain transparency. Secure supply chains support ongoing operations and build trade partner and customer confidence.

Regulatory Fragmentation as a Barrier: Cybersecurity regulation fragmentation between regions is a significant finding. Cybercriminals exploit loopholes in cybersecurity standards and data protection legislation, making compliance more difficult for multijurisdictional firms. Addressing these regulatory discrepancies requires harmonized worldwide cybersecurity standards and government-organization collaboration.

Cybersecurity as a Catalyst for Economic Growth: The research found that cybersecurity boosts economic development. Secure digital trade procedures boost customer trust, investment, and innovation, expanding cross-border e-commerce. Cybersecurity also helps SMEs compete in international markets, increasing economic involvement and inclusive development.

The results confirm that cybersecurity protects cross-border e-commerce and sustains global economic development. Addressing weaknesses, embracing new technology, and promoting international cooperation may help firms and governments build a safe digital commerce environment. These methods reduce risks and provide economic possibilities, ensuring that cross-border e-commerce thrives in a globalized society.

LIMITATIONS AND POLICY IMPLICATIONS

This secondary data-based analysis illuminates how cybersecurity protects cross-border e-commerce and boosts economic development. However, its literature-based approach restricts its capacity to produce primary empirical data or region-specific analysis. Certain conclusions may need to be updated due to the dynamic nature of cyber threats and quick technical improvements.

The results have significant policy consequences. Governments and international organizations must promote cybersecurity standard harmonization to reduce regulatory fragmentation. Collaborative threat information sharing and worldwide alliances must mitigate cyber dangers. Subsidies and training should encourage SMEs to use AI and blockchain cybersecurity solutions. Digital literacy programs that include cybersecurity education may boost customer awareness and trust. Addressing these policy issues would boost global e-commerce and inclusive economic development.

CONCLUSION

Cross-border e-commerce's explosive expansion has created enormous prospects for the advancement of the world economy. However, the cybersecurity threats that jeopardize the viability of digital commerce are growing along with it. This report emphasizes cybersecurity's importance in protecting international e-commerce and how it directly affects customer confidence, company viability, and economic expansion. The results show that secure digital platforms, particularly for small and medium-sized firms (SMEs) susceptible to cyber-attacks, shield against monetary losses and allow them to innovate and compete in a global economy. New technologies like blockchain, artificial intelligence, and sophisticated encryption are essential for bolstering cybersecurity frameworks because they provide companies with the means to detect attacks, protect transactions, and guarantee supply chain transparency. These technologies help the ongoing growth of international trade by improving the security of cross-border e-commerce.

However, issues like fragmented regulations and changing cyber threats remain. The report emphasizes the need for international cooperation to create standardized cybersecurity standards and regulations and guarantee a safe and reliable environment for online commerce. Governments must also incentivize companies to implement state-of-the-art cybersecurity safeguards to promote innovation and resilience in the global economy.

In summary, cybersecurity is a strategic facilitator of economic development rather than just a defensive measure. By embracing technical improvements and tackling current risks, stakeholders can create a safe digital infrastructure that promotes equitable economic growth globally and the long-term success of cross-border e-commerce.

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How to cite this article

Kamisetty, A. (2024). The Role of Cybersecurity in Safeguarding Cross-Border E-Commerce and Economic Growth. *Asian Business Review*, 14(2), 85-94. <https://doi.org/10.18034/abr.v14i2.739>